

Day-6

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Q. "The demand for smaller states reflects both democratic aspirations and administrative desperation." Critically examine this statement in light of India's federal structure, regional inequality and cultural diversity.

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Answer - The demand of smaller states on the basis of language, ethnicity, developmental needs etc. in the diverse, democratic and federal country like India, shows political consciousness. It also demonstrates the power of adaptability of India in a diverse democracy aligning with articles 2 and 3.

Demand of smaller states as Democratic Aspiration :

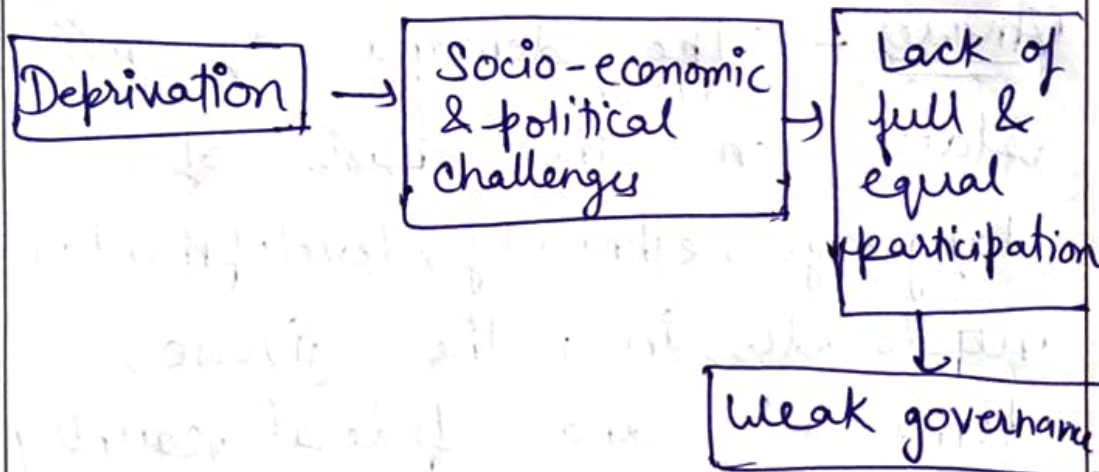
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① For decentralized and better governance.

Because the existence of culturally and socio-economically deprived section can lead to weak governance.



Thus, it is imperative to fulfill their demands.

② For political inclusivity

The participative democracy will be strengthened at the grassroot level if grievances of smaller communities will be addressed efficiently.

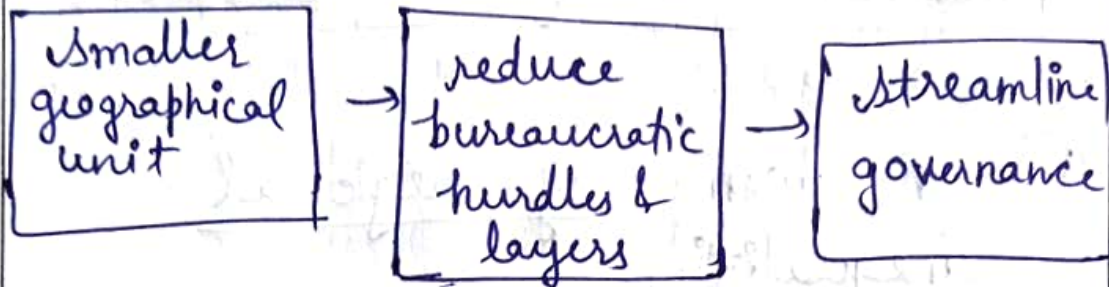
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As administrative desperation

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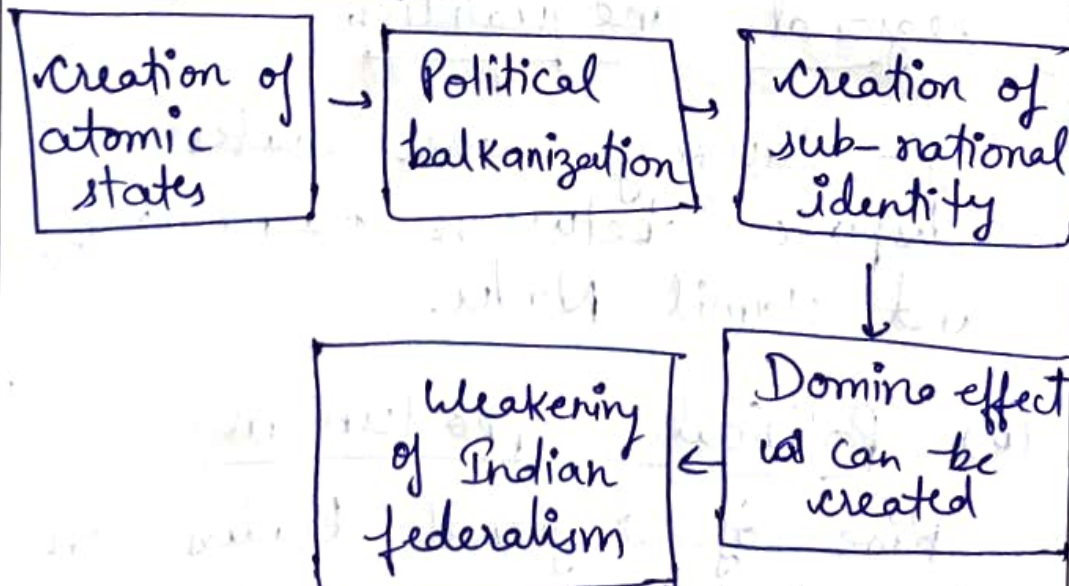
① for efficient administration



② faster implementation of welfare schemes

⇒ Critical Analysis

① In terms of India's federal structure



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eg:- Demand of separate statehood
for Gorkhaland, Bodoland,
Mithilanchal, Purnanchal etc.

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(2) In terms of regional
inequalities

(a) → Demand of separate statehood
over languages, cultural identity
and disputes over resources
like sharing of river water,
energy and minerals create
interstate contention and
regional inequalities.

eg:- Cauvery river water
dispute between Karnataka
and Tamil Nadu.

(b) Political Opportunism

Rise of regional leaders on
the basis of demand of

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separate state also create regional inequalities.
↳ It also undermines national priorities.

③ In terms of cultural diversity.

(a) Ethnoregional exclusivism may lead sectarian division, fundamentalism which can undermine cultural diversity.

b) It can also complicate the cultural integration of minorities and create risk of division over unity.

⇒ Way forward

⇒ Way forward

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① Local governance like Panchayati Raj Institutions and Urban Local Bodies should be made stronger in terms of funds, functions, functionaries and framework.

② Strong Conflict Resolution method should be adopted and their efficiency ~~sho~~ must be enhanced.

eg:- Zonal Council, Inter-state Council

③ Cooperative federalism should be promoted at both vertical & horizontal level.

④ Root cause of issues should be addressed and our cultural diversity needs to be preserved.

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Thus, the demand of smaller states is challenging in various aspects but it requires a multi-pronged approach to balance democratic aspiration, administrative desperation with national interest integrity. We also need to implement our Constitutional provisions in letter and spirit.

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